

levels were set to boost long-term healthcare demand because obesity-linked conditions increasingly require continuous outpatient care rather than episodic hospital treatment.

Data from the National Family Health Survey-5 (2019–21) show that 24% of Indian women and 23% of men are overweight or obese. The Indian Council of Medical Research-India Diabetes study puts the number of people living with diabetes in India at around 101 million, among the highest globally.

Together, obesity and diabetes are driving a growing share of outpatient visits, chronic drug use and healthcare spending. National Health Accounts data from the Ministry of Health & Family Welfare show that non-communicable diseases now account for over 55% of India's disease burden, with metabolic disorders taking up an increasing share of health expenditure.

Such numbers in India and elsewhere underline why drug makers are thinking beyond first-generation therapies. Market estimates place the global GLP-1 market in 2025 at over \$60 billion as treatment expanded from specialist endocrinology to primary care and long-term disease management.

HIGH COSTS, LOW PERSISTENCE

Alongside Novo Nordisk, Lilly and Amgen, companies, including AstraZeneca Plc., Roche Holding AG and Pfizer Inc., are building their own metabolic drug portfolios focused on GLP-1 and multi-hormone therapies which, sooner or later, will enter the Indian market.

As global drug makers build deeper pipelines around obesity and metabolic diseases, analysts caution that the Indian GLP-1

market remains at an early stage, marked by high treatment costs, low patient adherence to drugs and price sensitivity.

According to Sheetal Sapale, Vice President of Commercial Research at Business2Business platform Pharmarack, early prescribing momentum around tirzepatide, another diabetes and obesity medication, has been supported by its cardiovascular benefits while weight-loss outcomes

of Tirzepatide and Semaglutide remain broadly comparable.

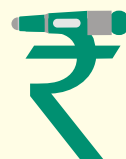
Sapale notes that demand has been driven as much by awareness and social media interest as by clinical outcomes, and cautions that side effects and the need for sustained lifestyle changes could limit long-term adherence.

These constraints are likely to cap how far the market can scale in the near term. Vishal Manchanda, Senior Vice President of Institu-

MOVING AHEAD



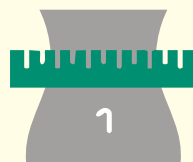
GLP-1 blockbusters are maturing fast, pushing drugmakers to plan beyond single-product strategies



India's GLP-1 market is high value but limited in scale, constrained by pricing and patient persistence



Price cuts and upcoming generics are intensifying competition for innovator brands



Future growth will depend on persistence and convenience, not just weight-loss efficacy



Pharma pipelines are shifting to multi-pathway therapies, combining oral, injectable and hormone-based options